START FROM SCRATCH / HYPER-PACED LEARNING

Week 1: AI fluency and mental models

A shared orientation for every week: connect where the cohort is now to the practical capability it will build next.

WHAT YOU ALREADY HAVE

You already use AI in web chats

You have seen AI generate, explain, and brainstorm. Now move beyond asking questions casually and learn how to collaborate with AI for product building.

THIS WEEK'S PLAN

Build the right mental model

Use Anthropic's 4Ds - Delegation, Description, Discernment, and Diligence - to decide how people and AI should work together.

RED FLAGS / TESTING

Do not outsource your judgment

Avoid vague goals, unverified answers, sensitive data in prompts, and treating fluent output as fact. Test against your own criteria and context.

EXPECTED OUTCOME

A responsible AI collaboration plan

You can choose what to delegate, describe a useful task, assess the output critically, and remain accountable for how it is used.

Start with the human judgment that makes every later model call, RAG workflow, and agent safer and more useful.

THE 4D FRAMEWORK

Four connected habits for working with AI

Anthropic’s AI Fluency Framework describes four competencies. They work together - not as a checklist completed once, but as a cycle of intentional collaboration.

Delegation	Set the goal. Decide whether, when, and how AI should contribute - and what must remain a human decision.	**Ask:** What is the job? What should AI do? What should it not do?
Description	Provide enough context, constraints, examples, audience, and output format for useful behaviour.	**Ask:** What does a good answer look like? What must the AI know?
Discernment	Evaluate the output and the process critically for accuracy, usefulness, relevance, and limitations.	**Ask:** Is this correct? What evidence supports it? What needs checking?
Diligence	Take responsibility for ethical, safe, transparent use of AI and for anything you choose to share or act on.	**Ask:** Is this safe to use? What should be disclosed? Who is accountable?

Explore the source material: Anthropic - AI Fluency: Frameworks and Foundations

WAYS OF COLLABORATING

Automation, augmentation, and agency

The 4Ds apply whether AI completes a specific task, collaborates with you as a thinking partner, or carries out a configured task more independently.

Automation

You specify a task and AI carries it out. Example: turn notes into a first draft.

Augmentation

You and AI work iteratively, each contributing judgment and ideas. Example: refine a plan through dialogue.

Agency

You configure AI to work toward a future task with defined knowledge, tools, and boundaries. Example: an SRE assistant that investigates an incident.

A good collaboration loop

1. Delegate
Choose a useful role for AI.

2. Describe
Add context and success criteria.

3. Discern
Check the output and reasoning.

4. Act with diligence
Use, revise, disclose, or reject.

Do not treat AI output as a final answer simply because it is fluent. Treat it as material you are responsible for assessing.

PRACTICE THE 4Ds

Bring one real task to AI

Choose a task you genuinely need to complete. The aim is not to write the most elaborate prompt; it is to design a responsible collaboration.

1. Delegate What part of the task will AI help with? What stays with you?	**2. Describe** What goal, context, audience, constraints, and format will you give it?
3. Discern How will you test the output for accuracy and usefulness?	**4. Diligence** What privacy, attribution, safety, or approval considerations apply?

Ready-to-discuss questions

- What did you delegate to AI - and why was that the right boundary?
- What changed when you added useful context and clear success criteria?
- What did you choose not to accept or use, and how did you decide?

AI fluency is the foundation for building. The next week turns this judgment into your first model call.